

THREAT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

SMS Phishing Campaign — Google Account Impersonation

Classification: MALICIOUS | Date: June 2026 | Analyst: Fernando Gesa | Platform: g-verify.app

CONFIRMED THREAT

5/91 VirusTotal vendors flagged malicious | Google Safe Browsing: Malicious | Newly registered domain (< 30 days old)

01

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report documents the analysis of a phishing SMS message received impersonating Google's account verification system. The message contained a malicious link to g-verify.app, a newly registered domain designed to mimic Google's branding and harvest account credentials from victims.

The domain is hosted behind Cloudflare infrastructure to conceal the true origin server and presents a convincing fake business landing page ("CloudRoute") designed to evade automated detection. Despite appearing benign on the surface, the domain has been flagged as malicious by Google Safe Browsing and multiple threat intelligence vendors.

02

INITIAL SMS ANALYSIS

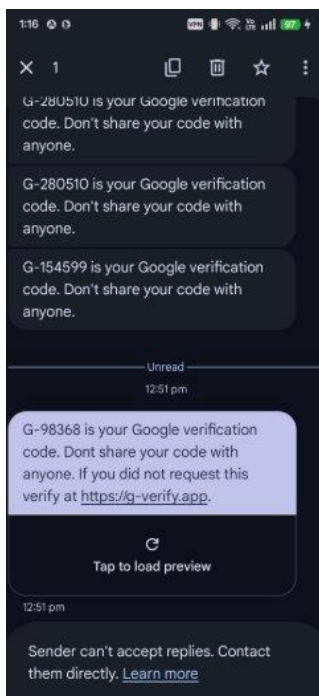


Fig 1: Phishing SMS

Message Content

The phishing message mimics legitimate Google verification SMS messages, which were also visible in the same thread. Key differences:

- Legitimate Google messages contain only: "G-XXXXXX is your Google verification code. Don't share your code with anyone."
- The phishing message adds: "If you did not request this verify at <https://g-verify.app>" — Google never includes URLs in OTP messages
- Creates urgency by implying unauthorised access to the account
- Blends into the conversation thread to appear trustworthy

Social Engineering Technique

- Urgency: implies account may be compromised
- Authority: impersonates Google using same thread as real messages

- Deception: domain name uses 'g-verify' to mimic Google verification

03

VIRUSTOTAL ANALYSIS

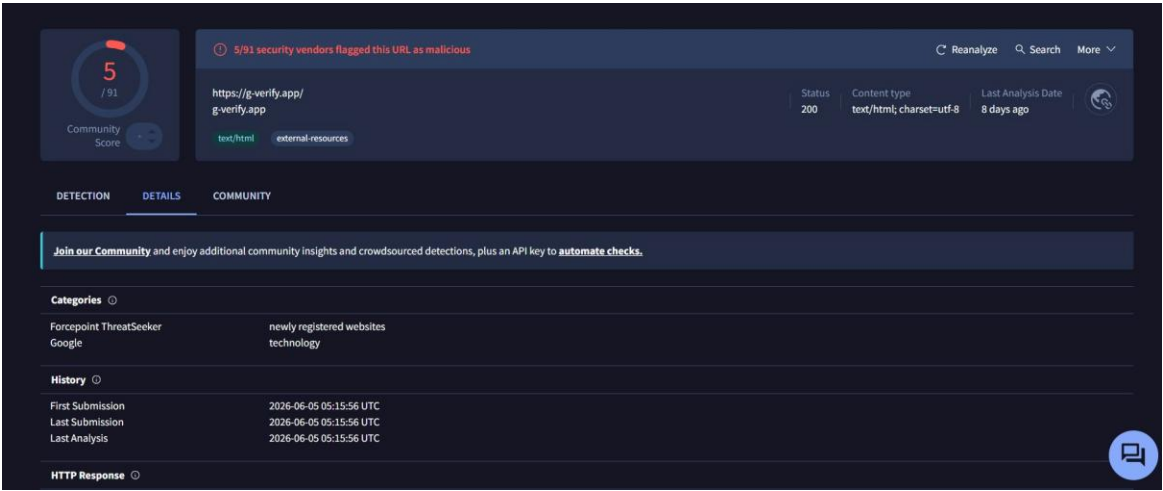


Figure 2: VirusTotal scan results for g-verify.app

Field	Value
URL	https://g-verify.app/
Detection Rate	5 / 91 vendors flagged as malicious
First Submission	2026-06-05 05:15:56 UTC
Serving IP	172.67.195.254 (Cloudflare)
HTTP Status	200 OK
Content Type	text/html; charset=utf-8
Page Title	API Platform – CloudRoute (fake business facade)
Category (Forcepoint)	Newly Registered Website
Body SHA-256	4fb47e83e1a6a9a87fbc137556ef2af7b0cf53fa9b03f25ca41f06d2b2bc20c7

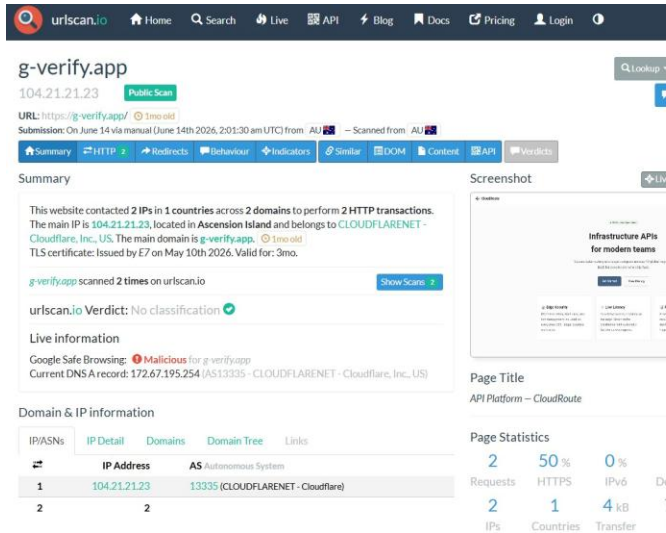


Figure 3: URLScan summary

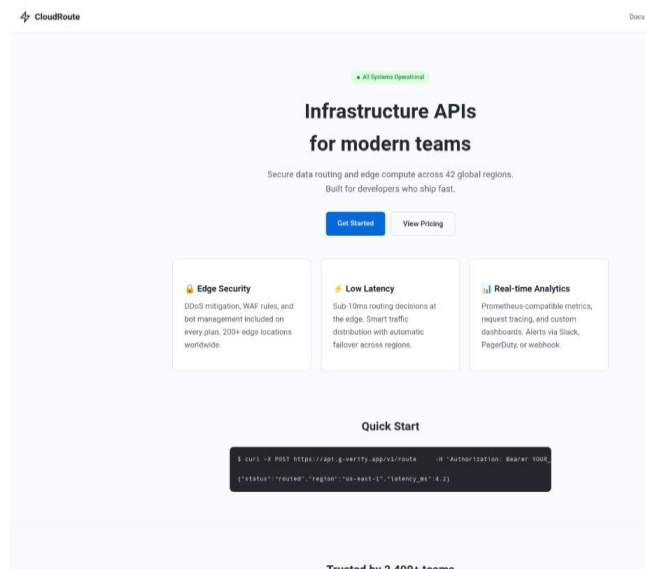


Figure 4: Live page screenshot

Field	Value
Google Safe Browsing	MALICIOUS
Domain Age	1 month old at time of scan
Main IP	104.21.21.23 (Cloudflare, Ascension Island)
DNS A Record	172.67.195.254 (AS13335 CLOUDFLARENET)
TLS Certificate	Issued by E7, May 10 2026 – valid 3 months only
HTTP Transactions	2 (minimal footprint)
Page Size	7 KB
Verdict	No classification (evading automated detection)

Hostname	Type	TTL	Priority	Content
g-verify.app	SOA	1800		kanye.ns.cloudflare.com dns.cloudflare.com 2406111763 10000 2400 604800 1800
g-verify.app	A	0		104.21.21.23
g-verify.app	A	0		172.67.195.254
g-verify.app	AAAA	0		2606:4700:3036::ac43:c3fe
g-verify.app	AAAA	0		2606:4700:3035::6815:1517
g-verify.app	NS	0		kanye.ns.cloudflare.com
g-verify.app	NS	0		lindsey.ns.cloudflare.com
g-verify.app	MX	0	5	alt1.aspmx.l.google.com
g-verify.app	MX	0	1	aspmx.l.google.com
g-verify.app	MX	0	5	alt2.aspmx.l.google.com
www.g-verify.app	A	0		172.67.195.254
www.g-verify.app	A	0		104.21.21.23
www.g-verify.app	AAAA	0		2606:4700:3035::6815:1517
www.g-verify.app	AAAA	0		2606:4700:3036::ac43:c3fe

Figure 5: DNS records

Suspicious DNS Indicators

- TTL set to 0 on all records — enables instant IP rotation to evade takedowns
- MX records point to Google mail servers (aspmx.l.google.com) — deliberate attempt to appear Google-affiliated
- Nameservers: kanye.ns.cloudflare.com / lindsey.ns.cloudflare.com — Cloudflare masking origin
- Both IPv4 and IPv6 configured — professional, well-resourced threat actor setup

Diagnostics

g-verify.app
Diagnostic Tools

Whois
RDAP
DNS Records
Uptime
Diagnostics
History

Hide Contact Info

Ping Results

PING g-verify.app (104.21.21.23): 56 data bytes
64 bytes from 104.21.21.23: seq=0 ttl=56 time=5.110 ms
64 bytes from 104.21.21.23: seq=1 ttl=56 time=1.949 ms
64 bytes from 104.21.21.23: seq=2 ttl=56 time=1.977 ms
64 bytes from 104.21.21.23: seq=3 ttl=56 time=2.008 ms
64 bytes from 104.21.21.23: seq=4 ttl=56 time=2.052 ms

--- g-verify.app ping statistics ---
5 packets transmitted, 5 packets received, 0% packet loss
round-trip min/avg/max = 1.949/2.619/5.110 ms

Figure 6: Ping results — ~2ms response

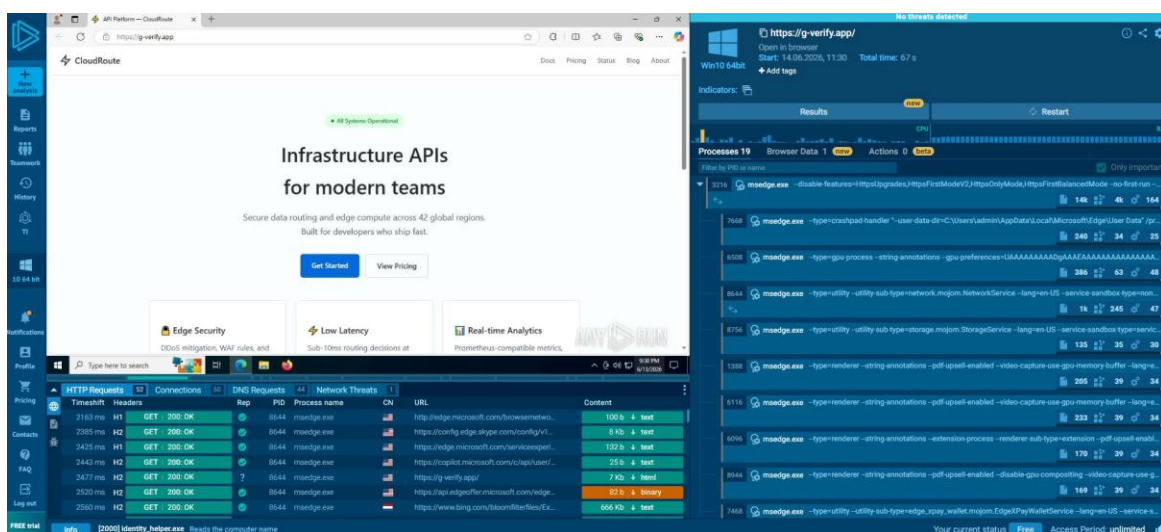


Figure 7: any.run sandbox analysis — Windows 10 64-bit environment

The sandbox reported no active threats detected in the observed flow. This is consistent with the site's evasion strategy — the malicious credential harvesting functionality is triggered by user interaction (clicking 'Get Started'), not on page load. However, the sandbox captured significant MITRE ATT&CK-mapped activity.

Sandbox Hashes — Main Object: g-verify.app

Hash Type	Value
MD5	03fef6d609bab26e316c7203291d9a45b
SHA1	09965f0b2c1660abc7969044e952e732c73f6433
SHA256	7f83b0a9bc17fff68e22514eef115c17d68b10ee7a10d8423ae0846122babd1f

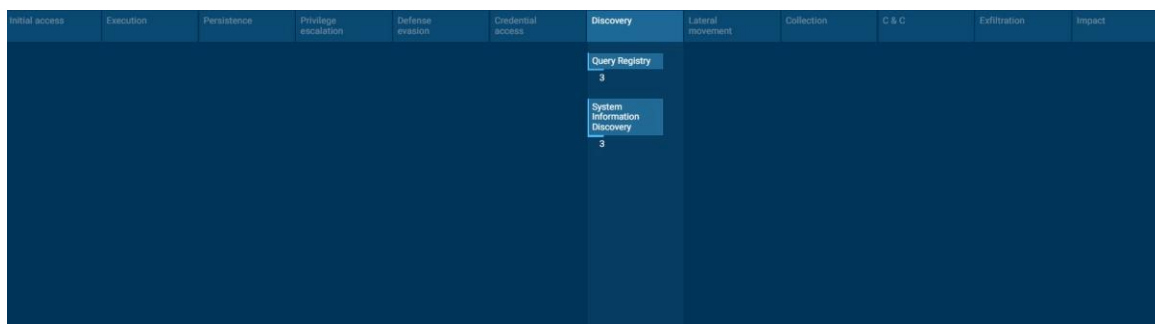


Figure 8: MITRE ATT&CK Matrix — 1 Tactic, 2 Techniques, 6 Events detected

Techniques details

Get to know what this threat is about

T1012

"Query Registry"

Permissions required: User, Administrator, SYSTEM

Data sources:

Adversaries may interact with the Windows Registry to gather information about the system, configuration, and installed software. The Registry contains a significant amount of information about the operating system, configuration, software, and security. (Citation: Wikipedia Windows Registry) Information can easily be queried using the Reg utility, though other means to access the Registry exist.

- Reads the computer name (1)
2000 identity_helper.exe (1)
- Reads Environment values (1)
2000 identity_helper.exe (1)
- Checks supported languages (1)
2000 identity_helper.exe (1)

Figure 9: T1012 — Query Registry

Techniques details

Get to know what this threat is about

T1082

"System Information Discovery"

Permissions required:

Data sources:

An adversary may attempt to get detailed information about the operating system and hardware, including version, patches, hotfixes, service packs, and architecture. Adversaries may use this information to shape follow-on behaviors, including whether or not the adversary fully infects the target and/or attempts specific actions. This behavior is distinct from [Local Storage Discovery](#) which is an adversary's discovery of local drive, disks and/or volumes.

- Reads the computer name (1)
2000 identity_helper.exe (1)
- Reads Environment values (1)
2000 identity_helper.exe (1)
- Checks supported languages (1)
2000 identity_helper.exe (1)

Figure 10: T1082 — System Information Discovery

Technique	Description / Relevance
T1566.002 — Spearphishing Link	Initial delivery via SMS containing malicious URL impersonating Google
T1056.003 — Web Portal Capture	Fake landing page designed to capture Google credentials via phishing form
T1012 — Query Registry	identity_helper.exe read registry to gather system configuration — victim profiling
T1082 — System Information Discovery	identity_helper.exe collected OS, environment, and language data to fingerprint the target
T1036 — Masquerading	Domain name (g-verify.app) and fake CloudRoute business page designed to evade detection
T1583.001 — Acquire Domain	Newly registered domain specifically created for this campaign

08 INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (IOCS)

IOC Type	Value
Malicious URL	https://g-verify.app/
Domain	g-verify.app
IPv4 (Cloudflare)	172.67.195.254
IPv4 (Cloudflare)	104.21.21.23
IPv6	2606:4700:3036::ac43:c3fe
IPv6	2606:4700:3035::6815:1517
TLS Issuer	E7 (Let's Encrypt) – issued May 10 2026
Page Title	API Platform – CloudRoute
SHA-256 (page)	4fb47e83e1a6a9a87fbc137556ef2af7b0cf53fa9b03f25ca41f06d2b2bc20c7
SHA-256 (sandbox)	7f83b0a9bc17fff68e22514eef115c17d68b10ee7a10d8423ae0846122babd1f
MD5 (sandbox)	03fe9d609bab26e316c7203291d9a45b
SHA1 (sandbox)	09965f0b2c1660abc7969044e952e732c73f6433
Nameservers	kanye.ns.cloudflare.com / lindsey.ns.cloudflare.com
MX (decoy)	aspmx.l.google.com (impersonating Google)

09 SOC DETECTION & RESPONSE

Detection Indicators

- SMS message containing URL not matching official Google domain (google.com / accounts.google.com)
- Domain registered < 30 days prior to campaign launch
- Cloudflare proxying masking true origin server
- Mismatch between domain name (g-verify.app) and page content (CloudRoute)
- Google Safe Browsing flagging domain as malicious
- VirusTotal detection across multiple vendors
- TTL of 0 on DNS records indicating fast-flux evasion capability

Recommended Response Actions

- Block domain g-verify.app and all associated IPs at DNS and firewall level
- Add IOCs to SIEM watchlist and threat intelligence platform
- Report URL to Google Safe Browsing:
https://safebrowsing.google.com/safebrowsing/report_phish/
- Report to ACSC via ReportCyber: <https://www.cyber.gov.au/report-and-recover/report>
- Report to Australian Communications and Media Authority (ACMA) SMS spam register
- If credentials were entered — immediately reset Google account password and enable MFA
- Alert users and security awareness team of active campaign targeting Google accounts

10 CONCLUSION

This phishing campaign represents a moderately sophisticated attack targeting Google account credentials via SMS. The threat actor demonstrated deliberate evasion measures including Cloudflare proxying, a convincing fake business landing page, short-lived TLS certificate, zero-TTL DNS records for rapid IP rotation, and system fingerprinting via JavaScript to detect sandbox environments.

The use of the g-verify.app domain to impersonate Google's verification system is a classic brand impersonation technique designed to exploit user trust. The campaign is actively targeting Australian users as evidenced by URLScan detecting the submission from AU.

All IOCs should be actioned immediately and the campaign reported to relevant Australian authorities.